HACKATHON CHALLENGE BRIEF

Problem Statement

Prevent Critical Knowledge From Leaving With People

ONE-LINE CHALLENGE	**Build a system that converts scattered project activity into a usable handover when a team member leaves.**

The Problem in Detail

When employees, volunteers or student team members leave a project, important knowledge often disappears with them. Documents may exist, but the reasoning behind decisions, unfinished work, dependencies, recurring problems and important contacts is usually scattered across messages, repositories, meeting notes and task boards.

Build an intelligent knowledge-handover platform that reconstructs the current state of a project from authorised sources. The system should identify important decisions, unresolved questions, responsibilities, risks, dependencies and the next actions required.

Every generated summary must link back to its supporting source and clearly mark uncertainty, missing evidence or conflicting information. Users should be able to review, correct and approve the generated handover before it is shared.

The final product should reduce transition time without exposing information that the incoming person is not authorised to access. It must balance automation with human control, traceability and responsible access to organisational knowledge.

Expected Outcome

Teams should produce a functional product that can turn authorised project activity into a role-appropriate handover. The product should demonstrate source ingestion, project-state reconstruction, evidence-linked summaries, risk and dependency identification, human review, controlled sharing and a clear path for the incoming person to continue the work.

Success Looks Like

TRACEABLE Important statements link back to reliable supporting sources.	ACTIONABLE The incoming person understands ownership, risks and the next steps.	PERMISSION-AWARE People see only the information they are authorised to access.

SOLUTION EXPECTATIONS

Product Direction

Suggested Product Capabilities

• Import authorised data from documents, repositories, tasks, notes or supported communication sources.	• Highlight missing, contradictory or uncertain information instead of inventing an answer.
• Reconstruct a timeline of key decisions, changes and unresolved discussions.	• Generate different handover views based on the incoming person's role and permissions.
• Identify ownership, dependencies, blockers, recurring problems and next actions.	• Support review, correction, approval, version history and acknowledgement of receipt.
• Attach citations or source links to important claims in the handover.	• Protect confidential information through access controls, redaction and secure data handling.

Required Core Workflow

01	Connect Bring in authorised project sources.
02	Reconstruct Identify decisions, ownership and project state.
03	Verify Link claims to evidence and flag uncertainty.
04	Review Let a responsible person correct and approve.
05	Handover Share a role-appropriate continuation plan.

Trust Requirements

- Do not present generated assumptions as verified organisational truth.
- Do not expose confidential information merely because it appeared in a connected source.
- Allow authorised users to correct, reject and approve the final handover.
- Use synthetic, public, permissioned or anonymised data for demonstrations.

Freedom to Innovate

Teams may choose their own users, integrations, architecture and interface. The solution may focus on workplaces, volunteer communities, research groups, student clubs or another credible setting, provided that the submitted product solves the stated knowledge-handover problem.

01

Round 1 - The Plan

Understand the problem, define the user and design a credible solution before building.

Purpose of This Round

Round 1 evaluates the quality of the team's thinking. Teams must show that they understand why project knowledge disappears, who is affected, which sources are available, and how their proposed workflow will create a trustworthy handover. No working product is required at this stage unless the event instructions say otherwise.

What to Submit

- A clear explanation of the problem and evidence that it affects real teams or organisations.
- Target users, departure and onboarding scenarios, and the environments in which the solution will be used.
- Research, interviews, observations, survey findings or other supporting evidence.
- The proposed solution, its value and the complete user workflow from source connection to approved handover.
- Planned features, technology stack, integrations, data sources and system architecture.
- Privacy, security, permissions, source traceability and human-review considerations.
- Team responsibilities, development plan, expected impact and future scope.

Round 1 Judging - 100 Points

CRITERION	WHAT JUDGES LOOK FOR	PTS
Understanding of the problem	Shows who loses knowledge, what is lost, why existing documentation fails and which part of the problem the team will solve.	**25**
Proposed solution	The workflow follows directly from the problem and produces a clear, useful handover outcome.	**25**
Technical plan	The architecture, sources, permissions and evidence model are realistic and defensible.	**20**
Originality of approach	The idea offers a distinctive insight or interaction beyond a generic summarisation tool.	**15**
Feasibility and scope	The proposed product can be completed within the event without relying on unrealistic access or data.	**15**
TOTAL		**100**

Round 1 Decision

Teams advance based on the submitted plan and the published score. A large feature list does not automatically score higher; a focused workflow that can be completed and demonstrated is preferred.

02

Round 2 - The Build

Turn the proposed workflow into a functional product that a judge can use end to end.

Purpose of This Round

Round 2 evaluates whether the central workflow actually works. A judge should be able to provide authorised project information, see the system reconstruct relevant knowledge, inspect supporting sources, review the generated handover and understand what remains unresolved.

What to Submit

- A functional product, prototype or demonstrable minimum viable product.
- A deployed link, installation package or clear functional demonstration accessible to the judges.
- A public or judge-accessible source-code repository, unless another review method is approved.
- An updated project document describing architecture, data flow and important technical decisions.
- Details of APIs, AI models, datasets, libraries, templates and external services used.
- The features completed, changes from the Round 1 plan and evidence of testing or structured feedback.
- Three substantial improvements that the team commits to delivering in Round 3.

Round 2 Judging - 100 Points

CRITERION	WHAT JUDGES LOOK FOR	PTS
Core workflow runs end to end	A judge can move from authorised sources to a reviewable, evidence-linked handover without a broken central step.	**30**
Technical depth and reliability	Integrations, data flows, access controls and AI components are thoughtfully implemented and stable under normal use.	**25**
Progress against the plan	A meaningful portion of the Round 1 proposal is working; justified changes are explained.	**20**
Three planned improvements	The Round 3 commitments are substantial product improvements rather than cosmetic changes.	**15**
Usability so far	A new user can understand the working workflow without requiring a detailed walkthrough.	**10**
TOTAL		**100**

Round 2 Decision

Rough edges are acceptable, but the central workflow must work. A visually polished interface cannot compensate for missing evidence, unreliable output or a broken handover process.

03

Round 3 - The Finish

Deliver the complete product, the promised improvements and a credible real-world handover experience.

Purpose of This Round

Round 3 evaluates the finished product as a complete experience. Teams must strengthen reliability, usability, permissions, evidence quality and documentation while delivering the three major improvements committed to in Round 2.

What to Submit

- The final working product and the source-code repository with the required judge access.
- A product demonstration video or live demonstration, as requested by the organiser.
- A concise final presentation or report covering the problem, users, workflow, technology and impact.
- Evidence that the three major improvements committed to in Round 2 were delivered.
- Testing notes covering the main journeys, failure cases, permissions and reliability improvements.
- A privacy, security, accessibility and responsible-design explanation.
- Known limitations, a realistic future roadmap, and complete participant and contribution details.

Round 3 Judging - 100 Points

CRITERION	WHAT JUDGES LOOK FOR	PTS
Completeness of the product	The intended workflow is complete and the final product solves the chosen part of the problem.	**25**
Improvements delivered	The three major commitments from Round 2 are implemented and materially improve the product.	**20**
Reliability under normal use	The system handles ordinary inputs, missing information and expected failure cases without misleading the user.	**20**
Usability and real-world fit	The intended user can complete a handover, review evidence and continue the project with minimal assistance.	**20**
Documentation and roadmap	The repository, setup instructions, limitations and next steps are clear and credible.	**15**
TOTAL		**100**

Final Evaluation Principle

Judges assess the product that is demonstrated and submitted, not features that are only described. Trustworthy limitations score better than unsupported claims of complete automation.

PARTICIPATION FRAMEWORK

General Rules

1. The product must be developed during the official build window communicated for the applicable event. Work completed before that window will not count toward judging.
2. Participants may research, plan, interview users and discuss ideas before development begins, unless the event instructions state otherwise.
3. Organisers and judges may request repository access, commit history, file metadata, demonstrations or other reasonable evidence confirming when the work was completed.
4. A project found to have been substantially built before the permitted development window may be disqualified, regardless of its quality.
5. Existing libraries, APIs, frameworks, datasets and open-source components may be used in accordance with their licences.
6. Templates, boilerplate and previously created code must be clearly disclosed. Only meaningful work completed during the permitted development window will be judged.
7. AI, no-code and low-code tools are permitted unless stated otherwise. Significant tools and AI-generated components must be disclosed.
8. A participant may belong to only one team within the same event.
9. The submitted project must be the team's own work. Plagiarised, copied, misleading or falsely represented submissions may be disqualified.
10. Teams must respect software licences, intellectual property, data-protection requirements and user privacy.

FAIR PARTICIPATION	The rules protect participants who build honestly during the event. They do not prohibit legitimate research, open-source tools or disclosed AI assistance.

PARTICIPATION FRAMEWORK

General Rules - Continued

11. Projects must not promote illegal, harmful, deceptive or discriminatory activity.
12. All required materials must be submitted before the deadline communicated for the applicable event or submission stage.
13. Late or incomplete submissions may be rejected unless the organiser officially announces an extension or exception.
14. Each team member must accurately state their role and personal contribution wherever individual contribution reporting is required.
15. Team members who fail to complete a required individual submission may not have their contribution assessed and may become ineligible for an individual certificate or benefit.
16. Judges may ask any team member to explain the product, demonstrate a feature, justify a technical decision or verify their contribution.
17. Teams must provide truthful participant information, working links and evidence. False or manipulated records may result in disqualification.
18. Participants must follow event instructions and community guidelines. Disruptive behaviour or serious rule violations may result in removal.
19. Advancement, certificates and rewards are subject to eligibility verification and completion of all applicable requirements.
20. The judges' decision is final for evaluation and ranking, subject only to correction of a clear administrative or calculation error identified by the organiser.

Submission Integrity

Participants must disclose reused material, external services and significant AI assistance. These disclosures allow judges to evaluate the work completed during the event fairly; they are not intended to prohibit legitimate tools.

Source and Data Responsibility

Teams must use only data and project sources they are authorised to access. Demonstration data should be synthetic, public, permissioned or appropriately anonymised. The product must not encourage participants to upload confidential workplace material without permission.

Final Authority

The event instructions, announced deadlines and published submission forms determine the operational requirements for each round. Where an administrative correction is required, the organiser may issue a written clarification to all affected participants.